Tabs: Authoring Guide

Audience: content authors and reviewers in AEM Universal Editor. Developers: see `docs/tabs/tabs-technical-guide.md`.

About the screenshots: they show the rendered sandbox pages from the local preview, including the hints and labels the Tabs container shows inside the editor. The Universal Editor interface itself (Content Tree, Add menu, properties panel) can't be captured from this environment, so those steps are described in text.

Status: tested in the local preview. Still to confirm in your AEM author environment: the Tabs container appearing under Add at page level, live updates after edits, and Content Tree selection opening the right tab.

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1. How tabs are built

```
Tabs                              ← the container (added at page level)
├── Title, Text ................. optional intro above the tab bar
├── Tab "Overview" .............. the tab's settings
├── Hero, Text, Cards, CTA … .... Overview's content: any blocks
├── Tab "Features"
├── Cards, Columns … ............ Features' content
└── Tab "Resources"
    └── …
```

- **Tabs** is a container that works like a section: you can add **any block** to it, including blocks the project adds later.
- A **Tab** starts a new tab and holds its title and settings.
- **Everything after a Tab, up to the next Tab**, is that tab's content.

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2. Create Tabs

1. Open the page in **Universal Editor**.
2. In the Content Tree, select the page's **Main** and click **Add (+) → Tabs**. The Tabs container is added to the page.
3. With **Tabs** selected, set **Tab Style**, **Orientation**, **Alignment**, **Mobile Behaviour**, **Theme Variant**, **Tab Size** and the toggles: **Enable Icons**, **Deep Linking**, **Sticky Tabs**, **Auto Rotation**.
4. Optionally add a **Title** and **Text** first. Anything before the first Tab is shown above the tab bar.

Until it has a Tab, the container shows this hint in the editor (visitors never see it):

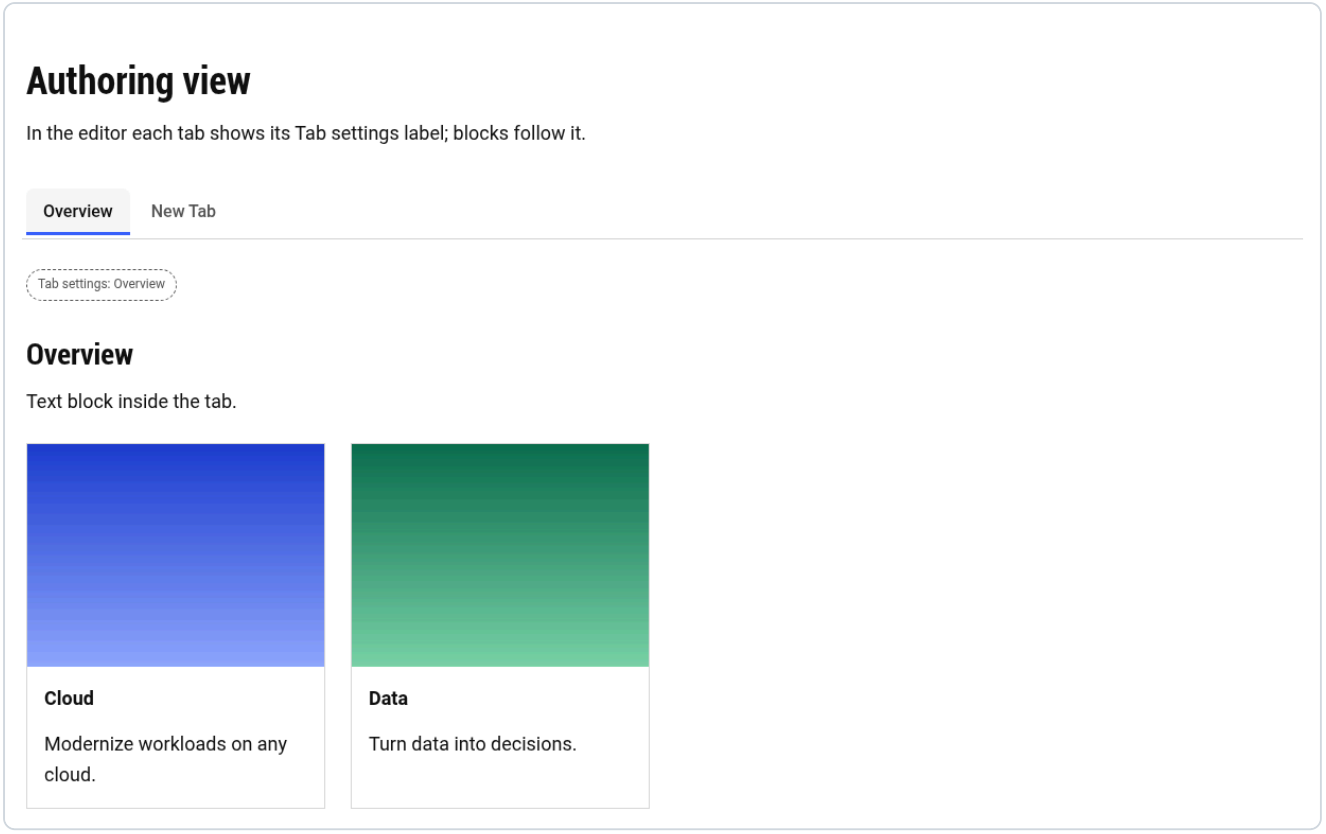


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3. Add a tab

1. Select the **Tabs** container and click **Add (+)** → **Tab**. It's added as "New Tab".
2. Place it where the tab should start: after the previous tab's content, or first in the container.

In the editor, each tab shows a small **"Tab settings"** label at the top of its content. Click it to select the Tab:



4. Configure a tab

Select the Tab (its settings label, or in the Content Tree) and set:

Field	Notes
Tab Title	Text on the tab (required)
Tab ID	Used in links, e.g. `features` gives `/page#features`. Defaults to the title.
Description	Shown on Card, Image and Mega styles
Icon	Icon name from `/icons`, e.g. `info`, `star`, `chat` (turn on **Enable Icons**, or use the Icon style)
Badge	Short label, e.g. "New"
Thumbnail	Image shown on the Image style
Analytics Label	Sent with analytics events, e.g. `overview-tab`
Default Active	Opens this tab first (the first one turned on wins)
Disabled	Shown greyed out and can't be opened

The page reloads in the editor after you change a Tab's settings, so the tab bar is rebuilt.

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5. Add blocks into a tab

1. Select the **Tabs** container and click **Add (+)**: choose any block (Title, Text, Hero, Image, Cards, Columns, buttons, Fragment, and any block your project adds).
2. Drag the block in the Content Tree so it sits **after the tab's Tab and before the next Tab**.
3. Edit, reorder and configure the block exactly as you would anywhere else.

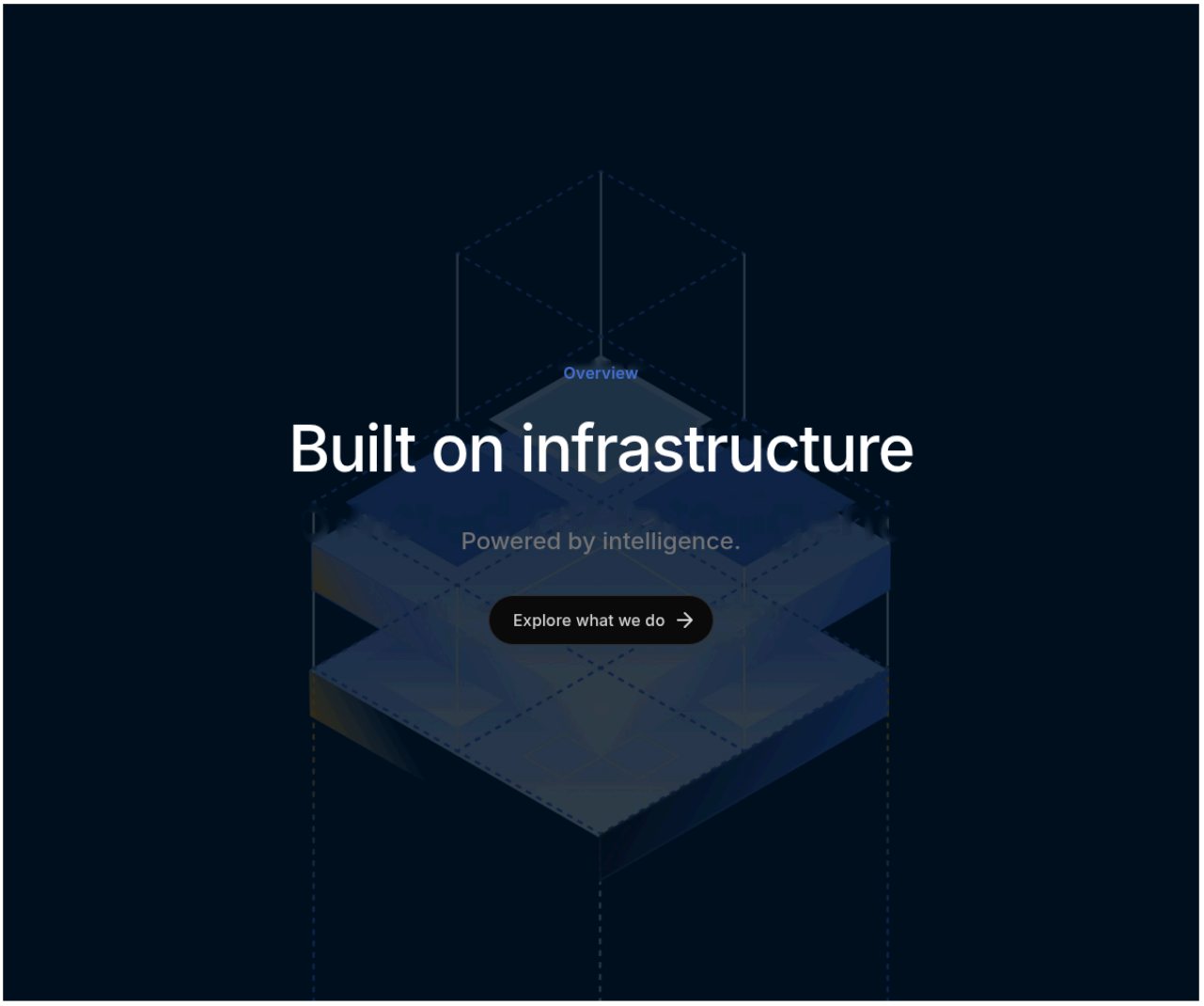
Selecting a block in the Content Tree opens its tab on the canvas.

Hero, text and button inside a tab:

Basic tabs

Hero, text and buttons, Cards, downloads and contact content, authored inline.

Overview | Features New | Resources | Contact

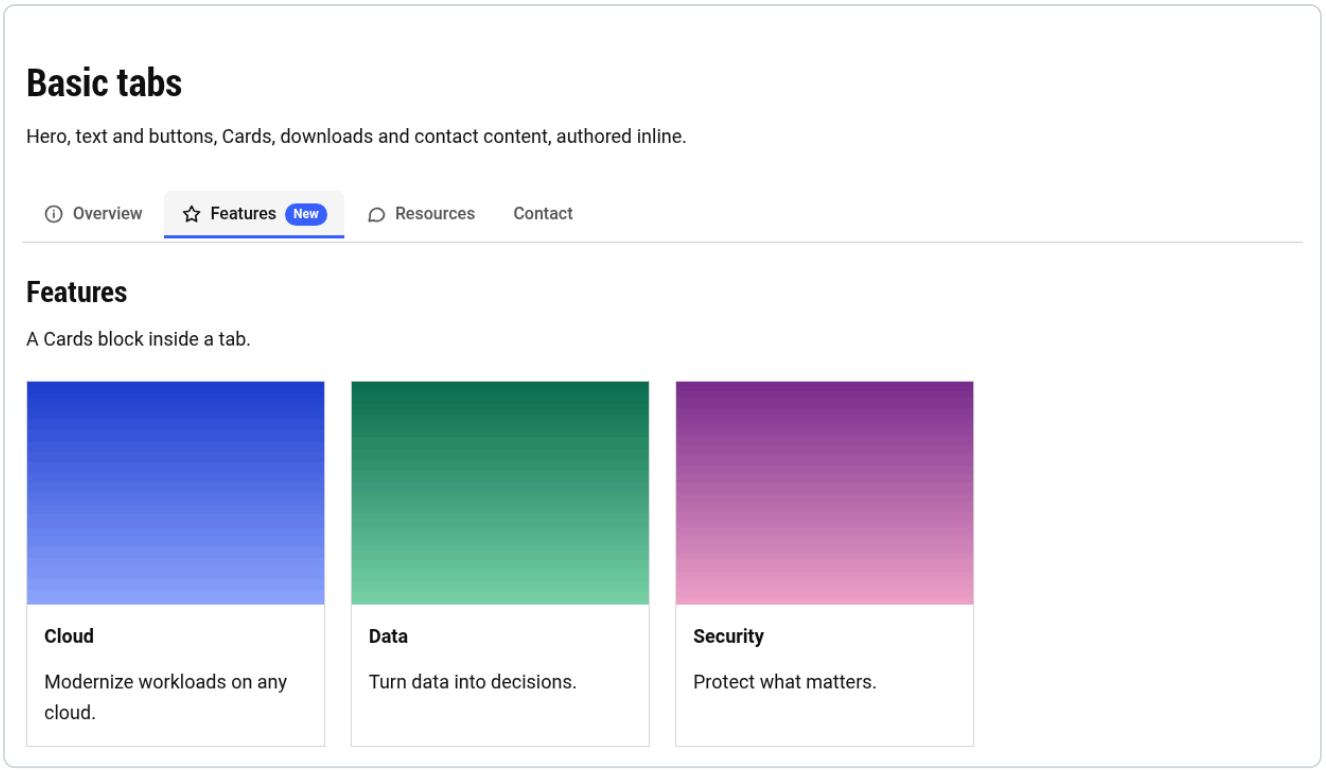


Why it matters

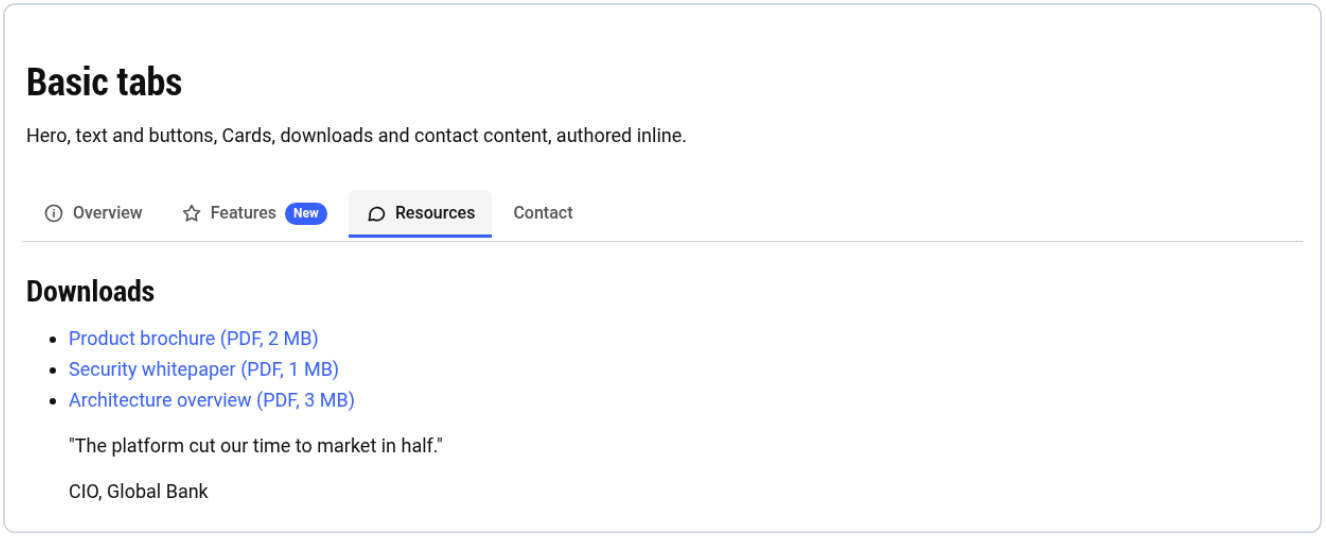
Default content works inside tabs too.

Talk to an expert

Cards inside a tab (loaded the first time the tab opens):



Downloads list and quote inside a tab:



> Carousel, Accordion, Forms, Video and Map blocks don't exist in this project yet, so they aren't shown. Once added, they work in tabs the same way and start up when their tab first opens.

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6. Reorder, duplicate, disable and delete tabs

I want to…	Do this
Reorder tabs	Drag the Tab **and its blocks** to the new position in the Content Tree
Rename a tab	Change the Tab's **Tab Title**
Duplicate a tab	Duplicate the Tab and each of its blocks, then give the copy a new Title and Tab ID
Disable a tab	Turn on **Disabled**
Open a tab **first**	Turn on **Default Active**
Delete a tab	Delete the Tab and its blocks. If you delete only the Tab, its blocks join the previous tab

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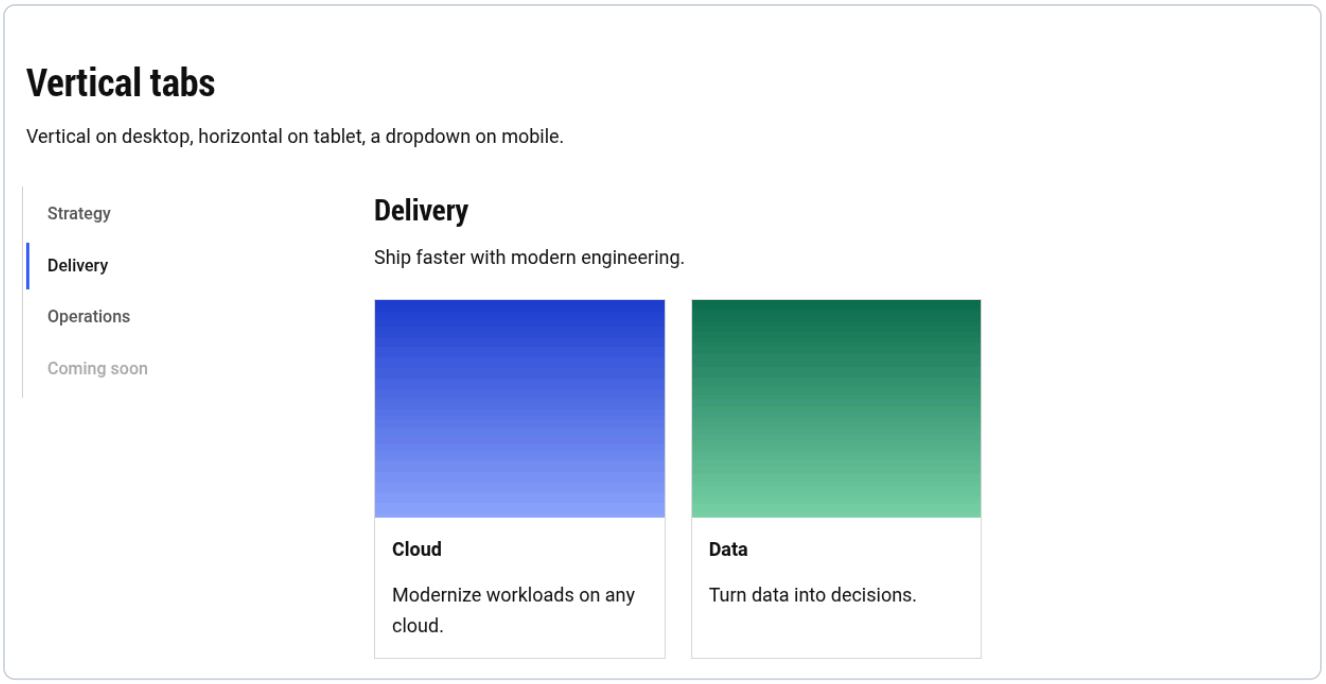
7. Themes and styles

Set these on the **Tabs** container:

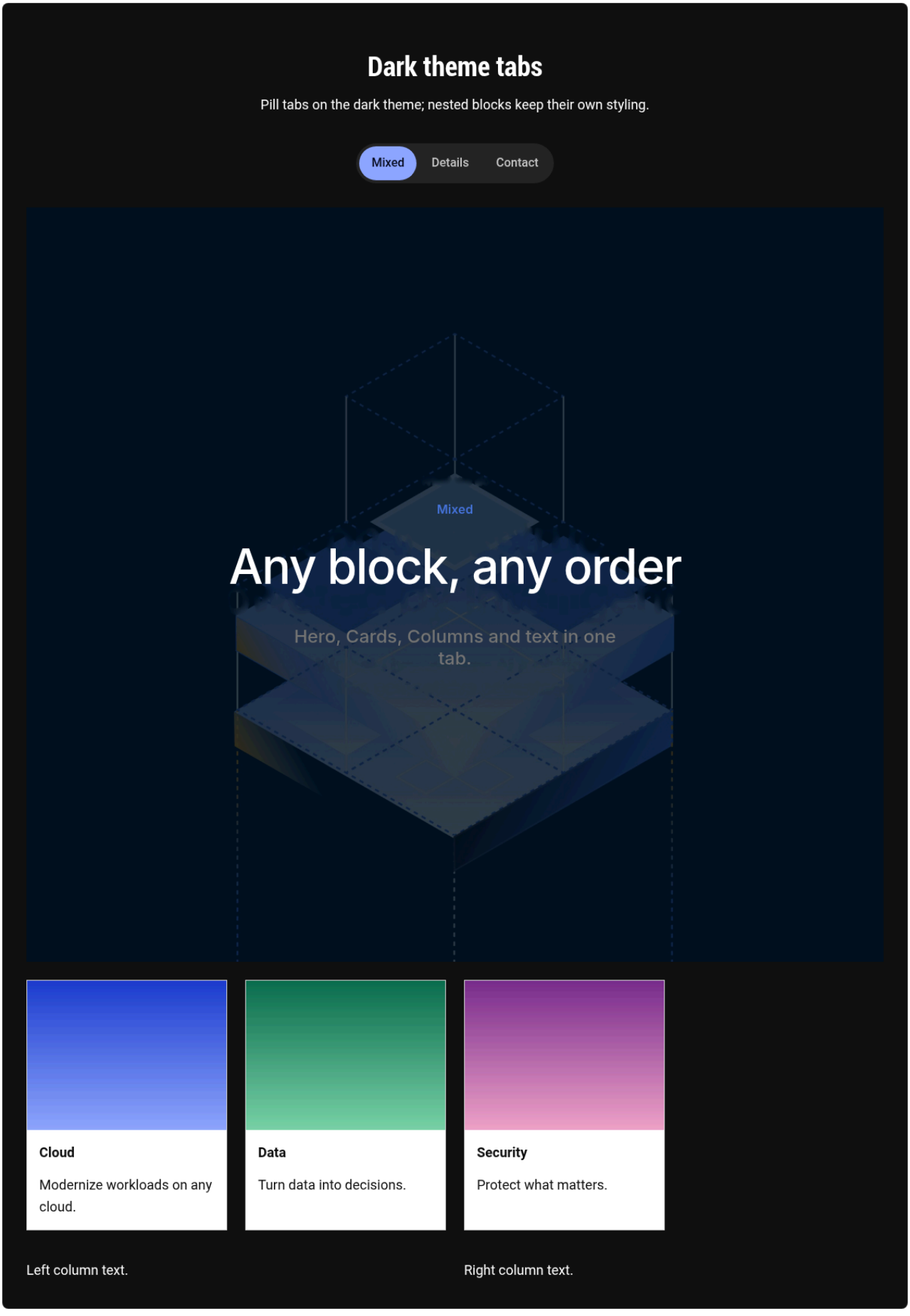
Setting	Options
Tab Style	Standard, Underline, Pill, Card, Icon, Numbered, Image, Mega
Orientation	Horizontal, Vertical (horizontal below desktop width)
Alignment	Start, Center, End, Full width (stretch)
Theme Variant	Light, Dark, Brand
Tab Size	Default, Compact
Sticky Tabs	Tab bar stays visible while scrolling long tabs
Auto Rotation + Speed	Pauses on hover and focus; off for reduced motion

Themes change the tab bar and plain text. Blocks inside tabs keep their own design.

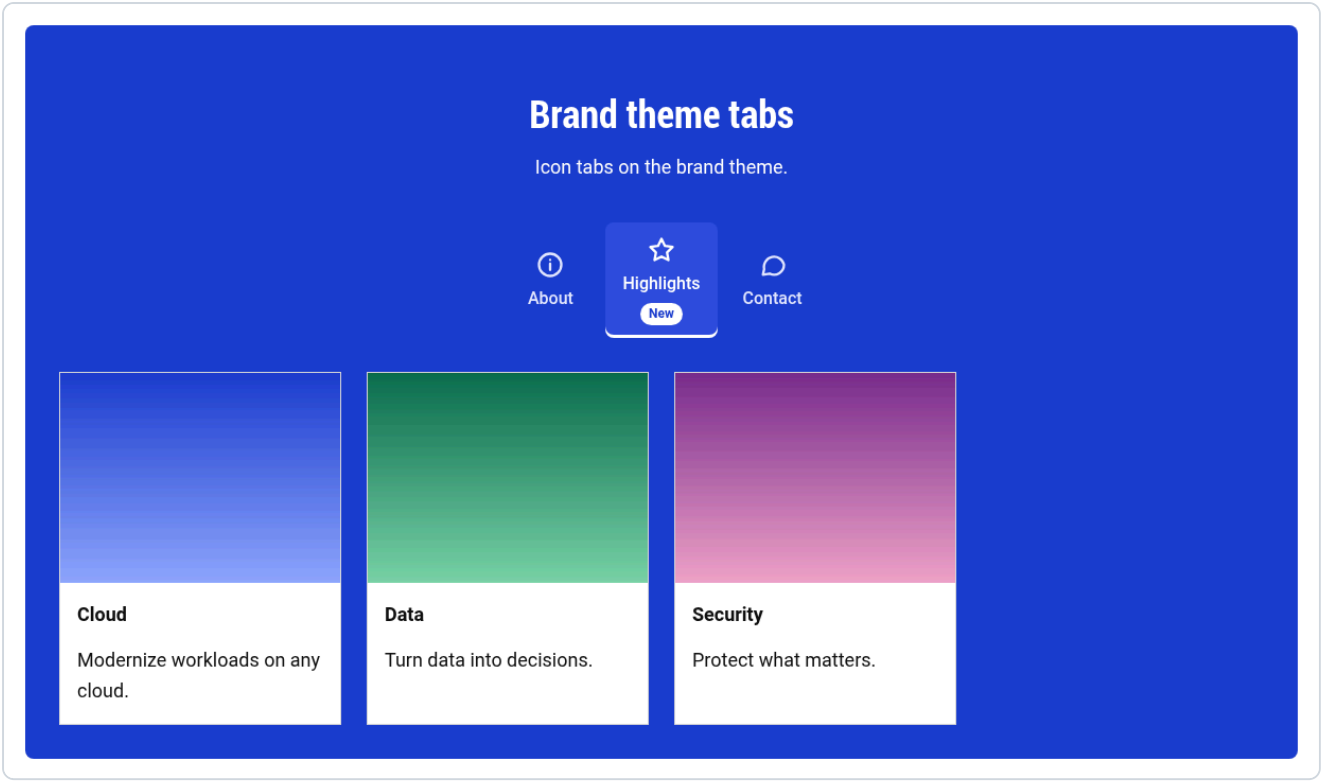
Vertical (Underline style, one tab disabled):



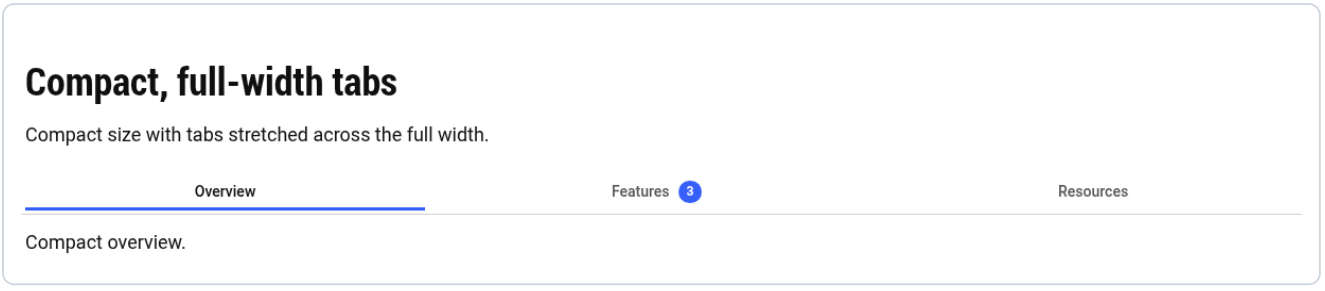
Dark theme (Pill, centred) with Hero, Cards and Columns in one tab:



Brand theme (Icon style, badge):



Compact, full-width tabs:



Mega: a Hero inside the tab spans the full page width:

Mega tabs

Full-width band; a Hero inside the tab spans the page.

Platforms
Enterprise platforms.

Products
Ready-to-use products.

Partners
Our ecosystem.



Platforms

Built on infrastructure

Powered by intelligence.

Cloud

Modernize workloads on any cloud.

Data

Turn data into decisions.

Security

Protect what matters.

8. Mobile and tablet

Choose **Mobile Behaviour** on the Tabs container (below 600px):

Accordion: each tab becomes a collapsible heading.

Basic tabs

Hero, text and buttons, Cards, downloads and contact content, authored inline.

Overview

Features New

Features

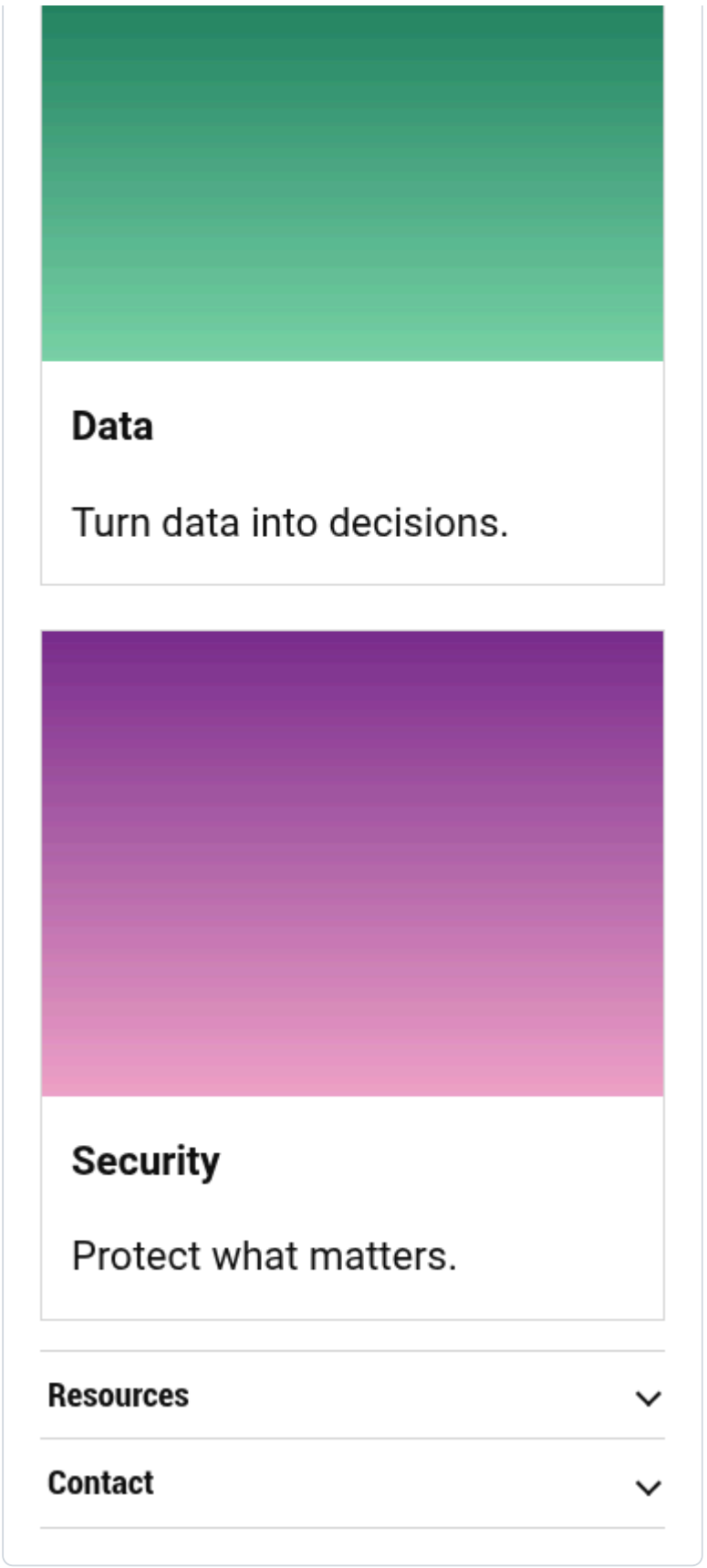
A Cards block inside a tab.



Cloud

Modernize workloads on any cloud.





Dropdown: a select menu replaces the tab bar.

Vertical tabs

Vertical on desktop, horizontal on tablet, a dropdown on mobile.

Delivery

Delivery

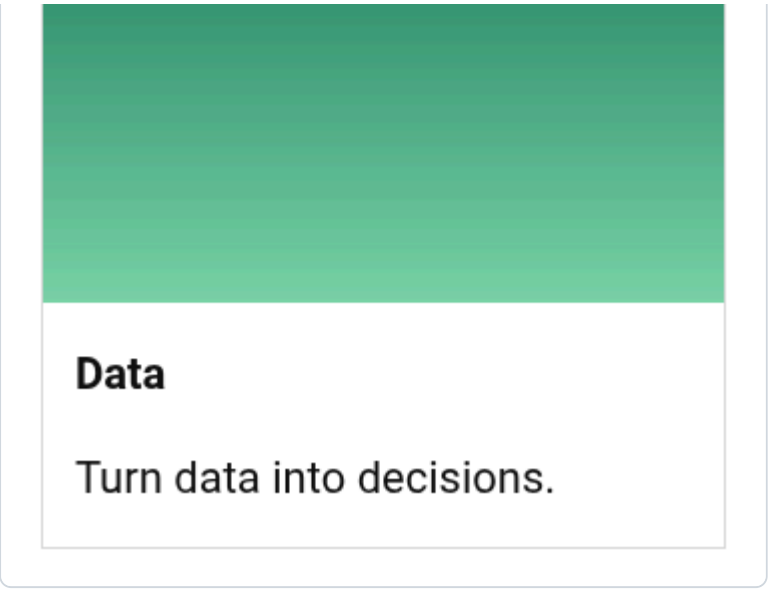
Ship faster with modern engineering.



Cloud

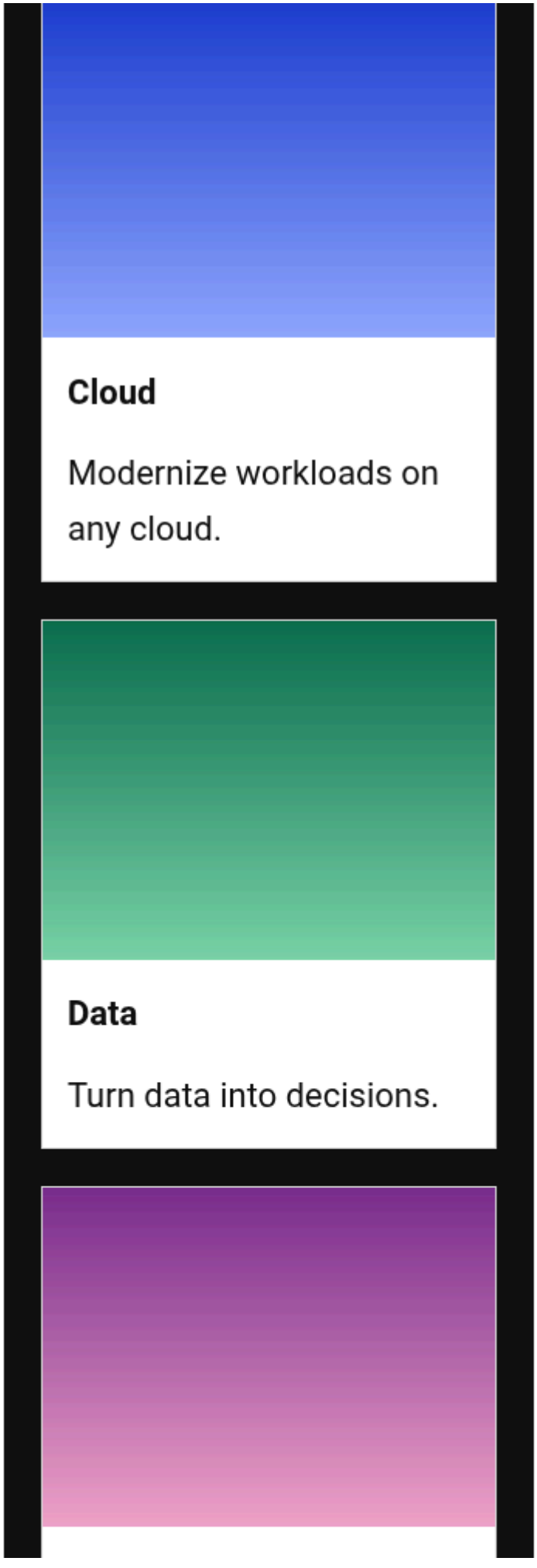
Modernize workloads on any cloud.

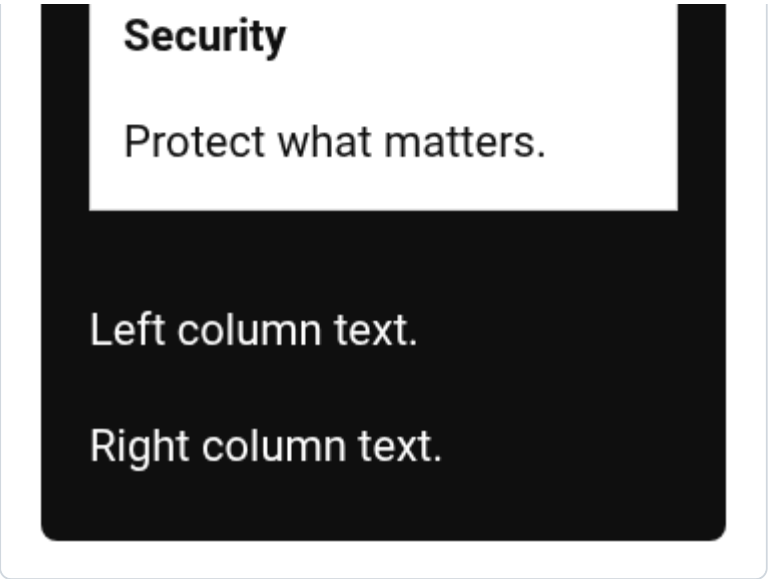




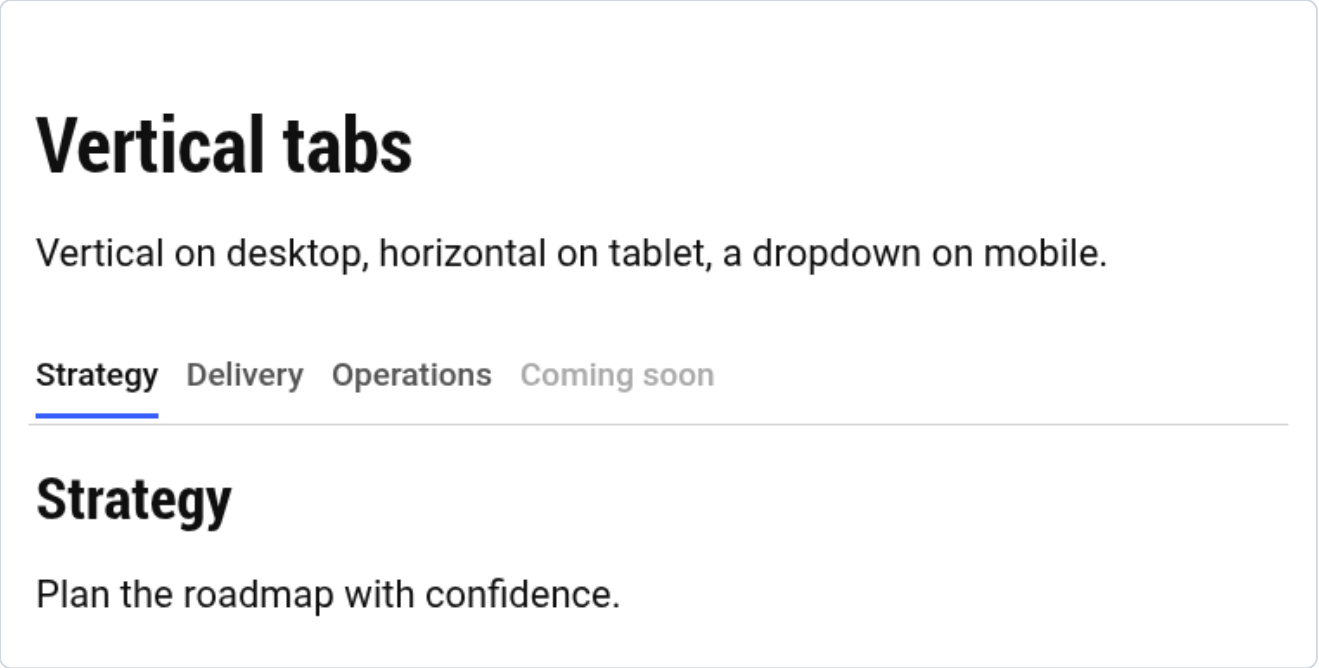
Scrollable tabs: the tab bar scrolls sideways.


Dark theme tabs
Pill tabs on the dark theme; nested blocks keep their own styling.
Mixed
Details
Contact
Mixed
Any block, any order
Hero, Cards, Columns and text in one tab.


Cloud
Modernize workloads on any cloud.
Data
Turn data into decisions.



On tablets, tabs are horizontal and scroll sideways when needed. Vertical tabs switch to horizontal:



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9. Links, history and analytics

- With **Deep Linking** on, the address shows the open tab (`/page#features`). Reloading or sharing the link opens that tab, and **Back/Forward** step through tabs.
- Link to a tab from anywhere with its **Tab ID**.
- Analytics events (viewed, clicked, activated, changed) are sent automatically with the page name, tab name, position and **Analytics Label**.

10. Accessibility checklist

Built in: screen-reader tab semantics, keyboard support (arrow keys move, **Enter/Space** open, Home/End jump), announcements like "Features tab selected, 2 of 4", disabled tabs announced as unavailable, visible focus:

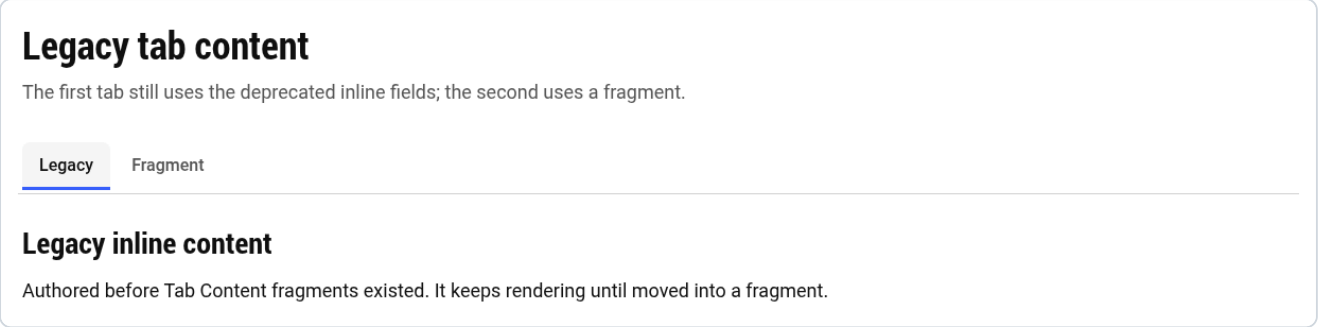


Authors should:

- Start the container with a **Title**, which names the tab bar for screen readers.
- Write short, unique **Tab Titles**.
- Use headings one level below the intro heading inside tabs (e.g. H3 under H2).
- Add alt text to meaningful images.
- Use **Auto Rotation** only for non-essential showcase content.

11. Older Tabs blocks

Pages built with the older **Tabs (legacy)** block keep working, and look and behave the same:



The legacy block can no longer be added. To move a legacy tab into the new container:

1. Add a **Tabs** container next to the old block.
2. For each old tab, add a **Tab** with the same settings, then recreate its content as **Title**, **Image** and **Text** blocks (or any blocks).
3. Delete the old block.

Tab Panel sections from the first version show as normal sections. Recreate them as tabs in a Tabs container.

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12. Troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
"No tabs yet" hint	Select the Tabs container → **Add (+)** → **Tab**
"This tab is empty" hint	Add blocks after that Tab, before the next Tab
A block shows in the wrong tab	Drag it after the right Tab in the Content Tree
"A Tab only works inside a Tabs section"	The Tab was added to a normal section. Move it into a Tabs container
Wrong tab opens on load	Check **Default Active**; a `#tab-id` in the URL takes priority
An icon doesn't show	Turn on **Enable Icons** (or use the Icon style) and check the icon name

To view the sandbox locally: `npx aem up --html-folder drafts --port 3001`, then open `/drafts/tabs`, `/drafts/tabs-mega`, `/drafts/tabs-editor-states` and `/drafts/tabs-legacy`.